Measure L

City of Santa Rosa

Measure Question

Simple Majority Needed to Pass

City of Santa Rosa Community Safety/Financial Stability Measure. Shall the measure maintaining Santa Rosa's quality of life, 911 emergency medical, police response to violent crimes; keeping all city fire stations open and public places safe/clean; fixing streets/repairing potholes; addressing homeless encampments; maintaining police, fire protection, other services, by reauthorizing the existing, voter approved sales tax at an updated 1¢ rate, providing approximately $46,000,000 annually until ended by voters; requiring audits, public disclosure, local control, be adopted?

What Your Vote Means

YES	NO
A "Yes" vote is a vote in favor of the Measure.	A "No" vote is a vote against the Measure.

For and Against Measure L

FOR	AGAINST
Mark Stapp Santa Rosa Mayor Sal Rosano Santa Rosa Police Chief Retired Anthony G. Gossner Retired Santa Rosa Fire Chief Hector Velazquez Local business owner Thea Hensel Santa Rosa Homeowner and Taxpayer	No argument was submitted against Measure L

Local Ballot Measure: L

Arguments and rebuttals are the opinions of the authors. They are printed exactly as submitted, including errors.

City Attorney's Impartial Analysis of Measure L

The City Council of the City of Santa Rosa placed Measure L on the ballot. If passed by the voters, Measure L would authorize a one-half of one percent (0.50%) increase to the transactions and use (sales) tax within the City. The tax would add $0.50 to the price of an item that costs $100, if the purchase is subject to sales tax. The tax would continue unless and until ended by the voters.

A transactions and use tax is commonly referred to as a sales tax. It is generally imposed on the sale or use of tangible personal property sold at retail locations within the City, subject to exemptions provided under state law. Exempt purchases include most groceries, prescription drugs, and services.

Currently, the cumulative sales tax in Santa Rosa is 10.00% of the purchase price. The City retains approximately 1.75% of the tax revenue; the remainder remains with the County or is distributed to the state or special districts. Part of the City's share is the 0.50% tax approved by voters in 2020 as Measure Q, which is scheduled to expire on March 31, 2031. Measure L would replace Measure Q with a 1.00% tax that continues unless and until ended by the voters. Measure L would increase the total sales tax rate in Santa Rosa by 0.50%, to 10.50%.

Because Measure L does not limit the use of tax revenue, it is a "general tax." Therefore, the City may use the funds for any lawful governmental purpose, and the measure only requires approval by a simple majority of voters voting on the measure. The City Council has identified priorities for use of the revenue from the tax: fire protection, 911 emergency response, police response to violent crime, fixing streets and potholes, addressing homeless encampments, and keeping public places safe and clean.

Measure L requires the City's independent auditors to prepare annually a publicly available report on the collection, management, and expenditure of revenue from the tax. Additionally, it requires all funds to be used only for Santa Rosa.

State law caps the local sales tax that a city may impose. The current cap applicable to Santa Rosa allows for a 0.25% increase. Measure L tracks Senate Bill 762, which permits the 0.50% increase that Measure L would authorize, and which the State Legislature passed and presented to the Governor on August 3, 2026. As of the date of this analysis, the Governor has not acted on SB 762. If SB 762 becomes law and Measure L passes, the new tax rate will comply with state law. If the Governor vetoes SB 762 and Measure L passes, Measure L's full 0.50% increase may not take effect.

If Measure L passes, the City would receive the full amount generated by the half-percent increase. Measure L is estimated to produce $46 million annually, including approximately $23 million in additional annual revenue compared to the existing one-half cent tax.

A "Yes" vote is a vote in favor of the Measure.

A "No" vote is a vote against the Measure.

/s/ Ashle Crocker
City Attorney

Argument in Favor of Measure L

Prevent devastating cuts to fire, police, 911 emergency services and the essential City services Santa Rosa residents rely on – Vote Yes on L.

Yes on L keeps Santa Rosa safe!

The City has already made cuts to our public safety and City services to address budget shortfalls. Enough is enough – any more cuts to our services will affect our neighborhoods and quality of life.

Yes on L prevents additional cuts and maintains services resident priorities such as fire protection and 911 response.

Yes on L ensures police response to violent crimes, fixes streets and potholes, addresses homeless encampments and keeps public places safe and clean.

Keep Santa Rosa Fire Stations Open!

The City doesn't have the funding to keep our fire stations open. Without Measure L fire stations may close on a rotating basis, slowing emergency response, fire response and putting our lives and property at risk.

Yes on L keeps all Santa Rosa fire stations open and running!

Protect Our Santa Rosa funding!

Yes on L keeps local tax dollars in Santa Rosa – accountable to you! Every penny must be spent for Santa Rosa and no funds can be taken by the County, Sacramento or D.C.

Yes on L includes strict accountability rules and fiscal safeguards, requiring independent audits and public reports to ensure funds are spent as promised.

Measure L is not a tax on your home or property.

Measure L is not applied to food purchased as groceries or prescription medication.

We must take action to protect our Santa Rosa public safety and City services. Join the Santa Rosa firefighters, police, local businesses, and your neighbors in voting Yes on L!

Get the facts: www.srcity.org

/s/ Mark Stapp
Santa Rosa Mayor

/s/ Sal Rosano
Santa Rosa Police Chief Retired

/s/ Anthony G. Gossner
Retired Santa Rosa Fire Chief

/s/ Hector Velazquez
Local business owner

/s/ Thea Hensel
Santa Rosa Homeowner and Taxpayer

No Argument Was Submitted Against Measure L

Local Ballot Measure: L

Full Text of Measure L

ORDINANCE NO. _____

ORDINANCE OF THE CITY OF SANTA ROSA AMENDING TITLE 3, CHAPTER 3-30 OF THE SANTA ROSA MUNICIPAL CODE TO ADJUST AND EXTEND THE CITY'S 2020 TRANSACTIONS AND USE (GENERAL) TAX

WHEREAS, in 2020 the City of Santa Rosa's voters approved a transactions and use (sales) tax rate of 0.50 percent. This existing general tax of 0.5 percent is in place until March 31, 2031 (Santa Rosa Muni. Code, ch. 3-30);

WHEREAS, the City Council wishes to ask the City's voters to adjust this general tax to 1.0 percent, and to extend that tax by removing its expiration date;

NOW, THEREFORE, THE PEOPLE OF THE CITY OF SANTA ROSA DO HEREBY ORDAIN AS FOLLOWS:

Section 1. Chapter 3-30, Section 3-30.015 (Operative Date) of the Santa Rosa Municipal Code is hereby amended to read as follows:

> "Operative date" means the first day of the first calendar quarter commencing more than 110 days after the effective date of this Chapter as amended by the City's voters in 2026.

Section 2. Chapter 3-30, Section 3-30.040 (Transactions Tax Rate) of the Santa Rosa Municipal Code is hereby amended to read as follows:

> For the privilege of selling tangible personal property at retail, a general tax is hereby imposed upon all retailers in the incorporated territory of the City at the rate of one percent of the gross receipts of any retailer from the sale of all tangible personal property sold at retail in said territory on and after the operative date of this chapter.

Section 3. Chapter 3-30, Section 3-30.050 (Use Tax Rate) of the Santa Rosa Municipal Code is hereby amended to read as follows:

> A general excise tax is hereby imposed on the storage, use or other consumption in the City of tangible personal property purchased from any retailer on and after the operative date of this chapter for storage, use or other consumption in said territory at the rate of one percent of the sales price of the property. The sales price shall include delivery charges when such charges are subject to State sales or use tax regardless of the place to which delivery is made.

Section 4. Chapter 3-30, Sections 3-30.120 (Effective Date) and 3-30.130 (Termination Date) are hereby repealed.

Section 5. The taxes imposed by this Ordinance shall remain in effect until repealed by the City Council or by the voters of the City of Santa Rosa.

Section 6. This Ordinance is exempt from the California Environmental Quality Act. (Pub. Resources Code, § 21000 et seq.) It can be seen with certainty that there is no possibility that this Ordinance may have a significant effect on the environment. (14 CCR § 15061(b)(3).) Further, this Ordinance simply creates a government funding mechanism, which does not involve any commitment to any specific project which may result in a potentially significant physical impact on the environment. (14 CCR § 15378(b)(4).)

Section 7. This Ordinance shall go into effect 10 days after the City Council declares its approval by a simple majority of the City's voters. (Elec. Code, § 9217.)

IN COUNCIL DULY PASSED AND ADOPTED by the City Council of the City of Santa Rosa, California, on this day of December, 2026, by the following vote:

AYES:

NOES:

ABSENT:

ABSTAIN:

RECUSE:

ATTEST: _____ APPROVED: _____
City Clerk Mayor

APPROVED AS TO FORM: _____
City Attorney